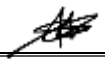
	Equipment Management	
	Document no: ASMF 6.4 Proc	
Compiled by:	Tshepo Maponya - Laboratory Supervisor	
Approved by:	Nonhlanhla Msibi - Operations Manager	

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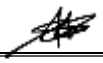
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1. Purpose & Scope

This procedure outlines the selection, identification, calibration, and maintenance of all laboratory equipment. This applies to all "critical equipment"—any hardware or software that can significantly influence the accuracy of laboratory results.

2. Selection and Verification

Before any equipment is placed into service (whether it is brand new or returning from repair), it must be verified.

- **Action:** The lab Manager/Supervisor compares the equipment's performance against the manufacturer's specifications or the laboratory's method requirements.
- **Record:** Identification & Verification results are noted in the **Equipment Register (ASMF 6.3 Equipment Register)**.

3. Identification and Labelling

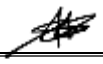
All equipment listed in the register shall be uniquely identified with a dedicated equipment number.

- **Calibration Labels:** Equipment must be labelled with its calibration status, indicating the **date of last calibration** and the **due date for the next calibration,** where necessary.

4. Handling, Transport, and Storage

To prevent contamination, damage, or deterioration:

- Equipment must be used only by authorized personnel.
- Sensitive instruments (e.g., balances) must be protected from vibrations and extreme temperature shifts.
- If equipment is transported outside the lab, it must be re-verified upon return before being used for testing.

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5. Calibration and Maintenance

- **Calibration Program:** The lab follows a schedule as defined in the **Equipment Register (ASMF 6.3 Equipment Register)**.
- **Service Providers:** Calibration is performed by accredited facilities (refer to **ASMF 6.2** for subcontracting/service provider assessment).
- **Intermediate Checks:** Where necessary (e.g., pH meters or scales), "intermediate checks" are performed between calibrations to maintain confidence in the equipment's status.

6. Non-Conforming Equipment

If equipment has been subjected to overloading, mishandling, gives suspect results, or is shown to be defective:

- **Isolate:** It must be taken out of service immediately.
- **Label:** A clear **"OUT OF SERVICE"** or **"DO NOT USE"** tag must be attached.
- **Investigate:** The lab must evaluate the impact of this defect on previous test results and initiate the Non-Conformance procedure if necessary.

7. Safeguarding

Equipment hardware and software shall be safeguarded from adjustments that would invalidate the test results. This includes password protection for software and physical seals on calibration-sensitive screws or knobs

8. Revision

Revision no	Content changed	Reason for revision

Effective date	Rev status	Next review date
01/2026	00	01/2028